

Academic Performance Task, Expectations and Rubric

The Task

Students begin by examining the amount of protected land in Canada. Each student is to select an ecozone, choose a park site in that ecozone, and develop a proposal for a new national park. In their proposal, students are to justify their site selection and the type of park they are proposing, and are to present collected research on the park's location, natural and human characteristics and other distinguishing features. Student are instructed to include supporting visuals, such as maps, graphs, charts, diagrams, or pictures, in their proposals.

Expectations

This task gives students the opportunity to demonstrate achievement of the following selected expectations from three strands: Geographic Foundations: Space and Systems; Understanding and Managing Change; and Methods of Geographic Inquiry.

Students will:

1. identify and analyse patterns of spatial organization, including land use, population distribution, and ecozones;
2. predict the consequences of human activities (e.g., agriculture, recreation) on natural systems;
3. demonstrate an understanding of how natural and human systems interact within ecozones;
4. describe biases in information and identify what types of information are relevant to particular inquiries;
5. demonstrate an understanding of the methods used to collect, organize, manipulate, and interpret geographic data;
6. locate and use effectively geographic material from primary sources (e.g., field research, surveys, interviews) and secondary sources (e.g., mainstream and alternative media, CD-ROMs, Internet) to research a geographic issue;
7. select and use appropriate methods for displaying geographic data;
8. create and use effectively photographs, charts, graphs, models, and diagrams;
9. use geographic data to support conclusions and opinions.

Prior Knowledge and Skills

To complete this task, students are expected to be able to demonstrate the following:

- knowledge of the definition of an ecozone
- knowledge of some of Canada's ecozones and their physical characteristics (e.g. landforms, climate, vegetation, and soils)
- understanding of the physical processes that have shaped Canada's ecozones (e.g. rock cycle; tectonic forces such as volcanism, folding, and faulting; glaciations)
- knowledge of purpose and types of national parks (e.g. for recreation, conservation, or preservation) and the characteristics of each type
- understanding of research methods using a variety of source materials
- ability to read, analyze, and interpret graphs and maps
- ability to use a variety of tools and technologies for research.

Task Rubric – Proposal for a New National Park

Expectations	Criteria	Level 1 (50–59)	Level 2 (60–69)	Level 3 (70–79)	Level 4 (80–100)
<u>Knowledge / understanding</u>					
1, 2	• Demonstrates knowledge of the selected ecozone • Demonstrates understanding of the relationship between natural and human systems	• Demonstrates limited knowledge of the selected ecozone • Demonstrates limited understanding of the relationship between natural and human systems	• Demonstrates some knowledge of the selected ecozone • Demonstrates some understanding of the relationship between natural and human systems	• Demonstrates considerable knowledge of the selected ecozone • Demonstrates considerable understanding of the relationship between natural and human systems	• Demonstrates thorough knowledge of the selected ecozone • Demonstrates thorough understanding of the relationship between natural and human systems
<u>Thinking / Inquiry</u>					
4, 9	• Uses a variety of relevant supporting facts and details • Explains the significance of the information selected	• Uses a limited variety of relevant supporting facts and details • Explains the significance to a limited degree	• Uses some variety of relevant supporting facts and details • Explains the significance to some degree	• Uses a considerable variety of relevant supporting facts and details • Explains the significance to a considerable degree	• Uses a wide variety of relevant supporting facts and details • Explains the significance to a high degree
<u>Communication</u>					
6, 8	• Uses visuals to illustrate the importance of the park site • Writes a clear and convincing proposal	• Uses visuals that illustrate the importance to a limited degree • Writes a proposal that is not very clear or convincing	• Uses visuals that illustrate the importance to some degree • Writes a proposal that is somewhat clear and convincing	• Uses visuals to illustrate the importance to a considerable degree • Writes a proposal that is generally clear and convincing	• Uses visuals that illustrate the importance to a high degree • Writes a proposal that is very clear and convincing
<u>Application</u>					
3	• Explains environmental and social implications of park development in the selected ecozones	• Shows limited understanding of the implications	• Shows some understanding of the implications	• Shows considerable understanding of the implications	• Shows thorough understanding of the implications